SUNLIT SEA

Sunlit Sea — proposed scope and budget for the EUPI-PV consortium

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Position document for the consortium alignment conversation. The call is HORIZON-CL5-2026-11-D3-14 (EUPI-PV Partnership): a €7.5M lump-sum HORIZON Innovation Action for an offshore/nearshore floating-PV demonstration of at least 5 MW across multiple EU climate or sea zones, reaching TRL 7-8 by project end, submission deadline 2026-12-01.

Sunlit Sea proposes to deliver the full 5000 kWp of Gen 2 FPV units required by the demonstration, split as 3.2 MWp at Gunneklevfjorden (Norway) and ~1.8 MWp at Clement's second EU site, and to build the project-dedicated first-of-a-kind pilot production line for that delivery. The Sunlit Sea share of the €7.5M lump sum is approximately €3.75M (half of the lump sum), backed by estimated eligible real costs of €5.4M and matched by €1.65M in Sunlit Sea's own co-financing.

Site split and responsibility matrix

The 5 MW demonstration is split across two sites to meet the call's "multiple EU climate or sea zones" requirement.

Site 1 — Gunneklevfjorden (Norway), 3.2 MWp

A nearshore basin inside Herøya Industrial Park in Porsgrunn. Sunlit Sea has operational responsibility end-to-end on this site:

- FPV units.
- Electrical works, DC and AC, up to and including grid connection to the Herøya industrial grid.
- Permitting (continues from Sunlit Sea's existing permitting work with Miljødirektoratet, Porsgrunn kommune and the Herøya industrial-park operator).
- Light anchoring and mooring, plus any required local wave attenuation. The anchoring work is tractable because the fjord bottom carries a capped layer left by Hydro's historical remediation of the industrial basin; the Norwegian Environment Agency has already accepted subsurface anchoring on this capped seabed. The site therefore does not need the full open-water mooring infrastructure a conventional offshore installation would require.

Site 2 — Clement's nearshore site in Portugal, ~1.8 MWp

Clement selects and develops a Portuguese Atlantic nearshore demonstration site to complement Gunneklevfjorden and meet the multi-zone requirement. (Inland water sites such as the Hainer See lake fall outside the call's offshore/nearshore scope and cannot be used for this demonstration.) Responsibilities at Clement's site:

- Clement: permitting, anchoring and mooring.
- Clement or a local Portuguese actor: grid connection to the Portuguese distribution network.

- Sunlit Sea: FPV units and DC electrical works up to the inverter interface.

Mandatory consortium roles outside Sunlit Sea's remit

The call requires an SSH expert, a permitting expert, a utility or grid operator, a precision-monitoring SME and a marine or offshore engineer. These sit with the coordinator and other consortium partners, not with Sunlit Sea.

Sunlit Sea does not take on the consortium coordinator role.

Budget

Estimated real-cost build-up (three-year project)

Category	EUR	Reasoning
Personnel	1 300 000	Approximately 130 person-months at a blended rate of €10 000 /PM. Production engineering, QA, installation leadership, electrical design and permitting at Gunneklevfjorden, Clement-site integration project management.
Equipment (project-dedicated)	1 500 000	FOAK pilot production line — pressing equipment adapted to Gen 2 float geometry, mould tooling, assembly jigs, in-line QC. Developed as part of the action work plan and written off at project end; zero expected reuse.
Materials (FOAK innovation delta for 5000 kWp)	1 000 000	FOAK premium on raw materials, PV modules and DC harness for the 5000 kWp batch. The commercial-asset portion of material cost is recovered post-project through site-owner PPAs and balance sheets; the project funds only the delta between first-of-a-kind unit cost and mature-state unit cost.
Subcontracting	400 000	Specialised installation contractors, external test laboratories, type approval and certification per site country, local low-voltage contracting at Gunneklevfjorden.
Other goods, works and services	100 000	Permits, insurance delta, multi-site logistics, dissemination.

Category	EUR	Reasoning
Travel	100 000	Multi-site visits, consortium coordination meetings, EUPI-PV reporting events.
Direct costs	4 400 000	Sum of the direct lines above.
Indirect costs	1 000 000	Horizon Europe flat rate of 25 % on direct costs excluding subcontracting.
Total estimated eligible real cost	5 400 000	Build-up backing Sunlit Sea's share of the lump sum.

Share of the lump sum

- Grant at HORIZON-IA 70 % funding rate: approximately €3.75M (50 % of the €7.5M lump sum).
- Required Sunlit Sea co-financing (30 % of estimated real cost): approximately €1.65M, paid from Sunlit Sea's balance sheet across the three-year project.

Share of the consortium envelope

Sunlit Sea's share corresponds to 50 % of the €7.5M EU contribution. The remaining €3.75M of the lump sum covers Clement's scope (second-site FPV balance-of-system, anchoring and mooring, grid interface), the coordinator overhead, and the mandatory SSH, permitting, utility, precision-monitoring and marine-engineering partners, plus R&D contributions by partner organisations.

Eligibility structure

The call explicitly limits what can be funded from the construction of the 5 MW demonstration plant. Under the portal Q&A, construction costs of the demonstration plant cannot be entirely funded by the project — only depreciation of equipment, infrastructure and other assets during the project period qualifies, and only to the extent of actual project use.

Sunlit Sea's build-up is structured to respect that limit:

- The project does not fund the commercial installed value of the 5000 kWp. The modules, floats, cabling and installation labour at mature-cost benchmarks of approximately €600 /kWp installed are recovered post-project by the site owners through power-purchase agreements, utility balance sheets and national investment instruments for renewable-energy deployment.
- The project funds the first-of-a-kind innovation delta: the premium between TRL 7-8 unit cost and mature target cost, the project-dedicated pilot production line (which cannot be depreciated against commercial output because it will be scrapped at project end), the R&D personnel driving design iteration and process qualification across the TRL 5-6 to 7-8 jump, and the data-collection and dissemination activities tied to the demonstration.

Under the lump-sum MGA the real-cost build-up above justifies the proposed lump sum at proposal evaluation; execution is milestone-driven, not invoice-driven. Under-delivery against a milestone means the lump-sum tranche for that milestone is not released.

Preconditions

- Co-financing. The €1.65M own-share across the three-year project period requires balance-sheet capacity on top of Sunlit Sea's existing SuRE co-financing and any obligations arising from the EIC Transition SUREWAVE application. Board confirmation of this capacity is a prerequisite.
- Gen 2 TRL readiness. Reaching TRL 7-8 by project end depends on Gen 2 being at TRL 5-6 at project start. The EIC Transition SUREWAVE project is the primary vehicle for the TRL 4-5 → 6 uplift during 2026-2027. Without an EIC Transition award, this scope is not deliverable and Sunlit Sea's contribution reduces to the fallback described below.

- Execution capacity. Delivering 5000 kWp of first-of-a-kind FPV across two EU sea zones at TRL 7-8, with full plant responsibility at Gunneklevfjorden, is a stretch on Sunlit Sea's current organisation. The build-up assumes staffing up during the project; the proposal narrative must set that expectation openly.
- Second-site location. The Portuguese nearshore option must be anchored by Clement during consortium formation. An inland water site such as Hainer See falls outside the call's offshore/nearshore scope and will not pass eligibility screening.

Scope fallback

If the consortium cannot absorb this scope — because the €7.5M envelope leaves insufficient budget for the mandatory consortium roles once Sunlit Sea takes €3.75M, because Clement cannot bring a second-site qualified under the call's offshore/nearshore scope, or because the EIC Transition SUREWAVE award does not land — Sunlit Sea can revert to a smaller contribution: hardware supplier for the Gunneklevfjorden site only (3.2 MWp), two WP contributions, and a corresponding budget share of approximately €0.8-1.5M. This fallback carries lower delivery risk and lower co-financing exposure.

Next step

Consortium alignment on scope and budget allocation before the proposal-writing phase begins. A locked position is needed in sufficient time to leave the writing phase intact against the 2026-12-01 submission deadline.

